

Absolutely — **number** is an excellent Tier 1 polysemy target because your passage uses it in two places:

> “I kept checking the latest **numbers**...”

and later:

> “What remains, however, is not the **number** itself...”

Here **number** means **a numerical count/figure representing views, likes, or other social-media metrics**. But the word also has major meanings involving **counting, phone numbers, identifying numbers, quantities, groups of people, songs/performances, grammar, and arithmetic**.

Word family: **number / numerical / numerically / numerous**

Base word: number

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Related adjective: numerical

Related adverb: numerically

Related adjective: numerous

Meaning in your passage: **number = numerical count / metric — 數字 ; 數量 ; 數據**

Your sentence:

> “I kept checking the latest **numbers**...”

Here **numbers** means:

> **the changing numerical figures showing things such as views, likes, comments, or followers.**

繁體中文 :

用數字表示的最新數據 , 例如瀏覽量、讚好數、留言數等

Natural translation:

> “I kept checking the latest numbers.”

「我不停查看最新的**數字 / 數據**。」

And later:

> “not the number itself”

means:

> **不是「100,000」這個數字本身**

So here:

> **number = 表示數量的數字 / 數據**

1. **number = mathematical/counting value — 數字；數**

The core meaning.

Practice 1

> “Seven is my favourite **number**.”

「七是我最喜歡的**數字**。」

Practice 2

> “Write the number at the top of the page.”

「把那個**數字**寫在頁頂。」

number = 用來表示數量、次序或數學值的符號 / 數值

2. **number = quantity / amount counted — 數量；人數；件數**

A major extension.

Practice 3

> “The **number** of views increased rapidly.”

「瀏覽**數量**迅速增加。」

Practice 4

> “A large number of students watched the video.”

「有**大量**學生看了那段影片。」

****number = 某一群人 / 物的數量****

This is one of the most common meanings.

3. ****numbers = statistics / figures — 數據 ; 數字表現****

This is your exact source sense.

Practice 5 — Original

> “I kept checking the latest ****numbers****.”

「我不停查看最新的****數據 / 數字****。」

Practice 6

> “The sales numbers looked strong.”

「銷售****數據****看起來很強勁。」

****numbers = 用數字表示的統計、業績或衡量指標****

Common in:

* business

* finance

* social media

* sports

* analytics

4. ****number = phone number — 電話號碼****

A very common practical sense.

Practice 7

> “What is your phone ****number****?”

「你的****電話號碼****是多少？」

Practice 8

> “I saved her number in my phone.”

「我把她的**電話號碼**存進手機。」

****number = 用來識別 / 聯絡電話線或手機帳戶的一串數字****

Context often allows just:

> number = 電話號碼

5. ****number = identifying/reference number — 編號 ; 號碼****

A major administrative sense.

Practice 9

> “Please enter your student ****number****.”

「請輸入你的學生****編號****。」

Practice 10

> “The parcel has a tracking number.”

「這個包裹有一個追蹤****編號****。」

****number = 用來識別某個人、物件、文件或記錄的編號****

Common:

- * ID number
- * account number
- * ticket number
- * room number
- * reference number

6. ****number = position in a sequence — 號 ; 第.....號****

Practice 11

> “She lives at ****number**** 18.”

「她住在 **18 號**。」

Practice 12

> “Bus number 12 stops here.”

「**12 號巴士**在這裡停。」

number = 用來表示次序、地址、路線或識別位置的號碼

7. **number = member/item in a set — 一項；一個**

A somewhat formal use.

Practice 13

> “That is one **number** on the list.”

「那是清單上的其中**一項**。」

Practice 14

> “Several numbers were missing from the sequence.”

「這個數列中有幾個**數字 / 項目**缺失。」

This sense is context-driven and lower priority.

8. **number = group of people — 一群；一些人**

A formal/literary noun use.

Practice 15

> “A small **number** of people stayed behind.”

「有**少數人**留了下來。」

Practice 16

> “A number of students complained.”

「有**一些學生**投訴。」

****a number of + plural noun = 一些 / 若干 ; 不少****

Important:

> a number of students ****are****...

because the meaning is plural.

9. ****the number of + plural noun =的數目****

Practice 17

> “The ****number of students**** is increasing.”

「學生的****人數****正在增加。」

Practice 18

> “The number of comments doubled.”

「留言****數量****增加了一倍。」

****the number of X = X 的數量****

Important grammar:

> the number of students ****is****...

singular verb because the head noun is ****number****.

10. ****a number of vs the number of — grammar contrast****

This deserves explicit treatment because it is high-value.

****a number of students****

= 一些 / 很多學生

→ plural verb

> “A number of students ****are**** absent.”

「有一些學生缺席。」

the number of students

= 學生人數

→ singular verb

> “The number of students **is** increasing.”

「學生人數正在增加。」

Excellent grammar/meaning contrast.

11. **number** = song/performance item — 歌曲；表演節目

A major entertainment sense.

Practice 19

> “The singer performed her final **number**.”

「歌手演出了最後一首**歌曲 / 表演節目**。」

Practice 20

> “The dance number was the highlight of the show.”

「那段**歌舞表演**是整場演出的亮點。」

number — entertainment = 演出中的一首歌、一段舞蹈或一個表演項目

This is genuinely distinct.

12. **number** = issue of a magazine/newspaper (較舊 / 正式) — 期；號

Practice 21

> “I found an old **number** of the magazine.”

「我找到一本舊的雜誌**期號**。」

Practice 22

> “That article appeared in the June number.”

「那篇文章刊登在六月**號 / 期**。」

number = 出版物的一期

Register:

* somewhat old-fashioned/formal

* lower priority today

13. **number = grammatical number — 數；單複數**

A linguistic/grammar sense.

Practice 23

> “English nouns can change in **number**.”

「英語名詞可以在**數**方面變化。」

Practice 24

> “The verb must agree with the subject in number.”

「動詞必須在**單複數**方面與主語一致。」

number — grammar = 單數 / 複數等語法上的數

Technical but important in language study.

14. **number = mathematical category / type of value — 數；數值**

A mathematical sense.

Practice 25

> “Negative numbers are less than zero.”

「**負數**小於零。」

Practice 26

> “This is an irrational number.”

「這是一個**無理數**。」

****number — mathematics = 數學中表示量、位置或關係的抽象數值****

This is close to core #1, so not a separate lexical concept, but important domain usage.

15. ****number = jersey/player number — 球衣號碼；選手號碼****

A common sports sense.

Practice 27

> “She wears ****number**** 10.”

「她穿 ****10 號球衣****。」

Practice 28

> “Number 7 scored the winning goal.”

「****7 號球員****射入致勝一球。」

****number = 用來識別球員 / 參賽者的號碼****

16. ****number = size code in some systems — 尺碼號數；型號****

Practice 29

> “What shoe ****number**** do you wear?”

「你穿甚麼****鞋碼****？」

Practice 30

> “This model comes in several numbered sizes.”

「這款型號有幾個不同的****號碼尺寸****。」

This is more natural in some varieties/languages than idiomatic everyday English in all regions, so secondary.

17. **number = verb, assign a number — 編號；給.....標號**

A major verb sense.

Practice 31

> “Please **number** the pages.”

「請給頁面**編號**。」

Practice 32

> “The seats are numbered from 1 to 50.”

「座位由 1 至 50 **編號**。」

number = 給人 / 物加上號碼，以便排列或識別

18. **number = verb, total / amount to — 總數為；共計**

A formal verb sense.

Practice 33

> “The audience **numbered** more than 2,000.”

「觀眾**共有**超過二千人。」

Practice 34

> “The collection numbers nearly 500 items.”

「這個收藏**共有**接近五百件物品。」

number = 總數達到某個數量

Register:

* formal

19. **number among = 把.....列為；屬於.....之一**

A formal construction.

Practice 35

> “She numbers several famous writers among her friends.”

「她的朋友當中**包括**幾位著名作家。」

Practice 36

> “The city numbers many historic buildings among its attractions.”

「這座城市的景點中**包括**不少歷史建築。」

number X among Y = 把 X 算作 Y 之中的一員

Formal and lower priority.

20. **numerical = relating to numbers — 數字的；數值的**

Practice 37

> “The report contains **numerical** data.”

「報告包含**數值資料**。」

Practice 38

> “The answers must be given in numerical form.”

「答案必須以**數字形式**提供。」

numerical = 與數字 / 數值有關的

21. **numerically = in numerical terms/order — 以數值計；按數字順序**

Practice 39

> “The files are arranged **numerically**.”

「檔案按**數字順序**排列。」

Practice 40

> “The group is numerically small.”

「這個群體在**人數上**很少。」

numerically = 從數量 / 數值角度而言；按數字方式

22. **numerous** = many — 許多的；眾多的

A useful family extension, though its meaning has moved away from literal “number”.

Practice 41

> “The video received **numerous** comments.”

「那段影片收到**大量**留言。」

Practice 42

> “She faced numerous problems.”

「她面對**許多**問題。」

numerous = 數量很多的

23. **number one** = 最重要的；首要的；第一名

A highly common expression.

Practice 43

> “Quality is our **number one** priority.”

「品質是我們的**首要**考慮。」

Practice 44

> “The song reached number one.”

「那首歌登上了**排行榜第一名**。」

number one = 排名第一 / 最重要的

24. **one's number is up (較口語) = 大限已到 ; 完蛋了**

An idiom worth recognizing, but lower priority.

Practice 45

> “He thought his **number was up**.”

「他以為自己**完蛋了 / 大限已到**。」

Practice 46

> “When the police arrived, he knew his number was up.”

「警察到達時，他知道自己**走投無路了**。」

one's number is up = 某人將遭遇嚴重後果 / 生命將盡

Register:

* informal

* idiomatic

Important distinction: **number vs figure**

number

= numerical value or quantity broadly.

figure

often:

= a specific numerical amount/statistic.

> number of views

> = 瀏覽量

> latest sales figures

> = 最新銷售數字

In business/statistics, they overlap strongly.

Important distinction: **number vs amount**

number

normally with countable things.

> number of comments

amount

normally with uncountable things.

> amount of attention

So:

> number of students ✓

> amount of water ✓

This is a very important learner distinction.

Important distinction: **number vs quantity**

number

very common with countable items.

quantity

more formal/general and can refer to measurable amounts.

> number of videos

> = 影片數量

> quantity of flour

> = 麵粉份量

Important distinction: **number** vs **digit**

number

= complete numerical value.

digit

= one symbol from 0–9.

Example:

> 527 is a number

> 5, 2, and 7 are digits

So:

* number = 數字 / 數

* digit = 位數 / 數字符號

Important distinction: **number** vs **numeral**

number

= abstract mathematical value.

numeral

= symbol/word used to represent that number.

Example:

> the number five

> = 數值「五」

> numeral “5”

> = 表示五的符號「5」

Technical but useful.

Important distinction: ****number — quantity vs identifier****

Quantity:

> “The number of likes increased.”

= 讚好數量增加。

Identifier:

> “My student number is 12345.”

= 我的學生編號是 12345。

Same word, different function.

Important distinction: ****number — statistic vs phone number****

Statistic:

> “The numbers look good.”

= 數據看起來不錯。

Contact detail:

> “Give me your number.”

= 把你的電話號碼給我。

Context completely changes the meaning.

Important distinction: ****numbers — social media in your passage****

> “checking the latest numbers”

does ****not**** merely mean:

> checking random mathematical numbers.

It specifically means:

> **checking changing social-media metrics such as views, likes, or comments**

Natural Chinese:

* 數據

* 數字

* 指標

depending on context.

Important distinction: **a number of vs the number of**

This is one of the highest-value grammar traps.

> **A number of comments were negative.**

> = 有一些留言是負面的。

> **The number of comments was increasing.**

> = 留言數量正在增加。

So:

* **a number of + plural noun + plural verb**

* **the number of + plural noun + singular verb**

Important distinction: **number — entertainment**

> “The singer performed a number.”

does **not** mean:

> the singer performed a mathematical number.

It means:

> **演唱 / 表演了一個節目**

Strong lexical contrast.

Important distinction: **number — verb assign vs total**

Assign:

> “Number the pages.”

= 給頁面編號。

Total:

> “The audience numbered 3,000.”

= 觀眾共有三千人。

Same verb, different meaning.

Family-extension sweep

After the full audit, the useful modern inventory includes:

- * **number — mathematical value** = 數字 / 數
- * **number — quantity** = 數量 / 人數
- * **numbers — statistics** = 數據 / 統計數字
- * **number — phone** = 電話號碼
- * **number — identifier** = 編號 / 號碼
- * **number — sequence/address/route** = 第.....號 / 號碼
- * **a number of** = 一些 / 若干
- * **the number of** =的數量
- * **number — performance** = 歌曲 / 表演節目
- * **number — grammar** = 單複數等語法上的「數」
- * **number — sports** = 球衣 / 選手號碼
- * **number — verb assign** = 編號
- * **number — verb total** = 總數為 / 共計
- * **number one** = 第一名 / 首要的
- * **numerical** = 數字 / 數值的
- * **numerically** = 按數值 / 從數量上
- * **numerous** = 許多的

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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number — basic	用來表示數量、次序或數學值的數字 / 數
number — quantity	某一群人或物的數量
numbers — statistics	用數字表示的統計、業績或衡量指標
number — phone	用來聯絡某部電話 / 手機的一串號碼
number — identifier	用來識別人、物件、文件或帳戶的編號
a number of	一些 / 若干數量的
the number of	某群體 / 事物的總數
number — performance	演出中的一首歌、一段舞蹈或一個表演項目
number — grammar	名詞 / 動詞等在單數、複數方面的語法特徵
number — verb: assign	給人 / 物加上號碼作排列或識別
number — verb: total	總數達到某個數量
number one	排名第一；最重要 / 首要的
numerical	與數字、數值有關的
numerous	數量很多的

For your original passage

You have:

> “I kept checking the latest ****numbers****, wondering whether the video had reached 120,000 or 130,000 views.”

and later:

> “What remains, however, is not the ****number**** itself but the lesson behind it.”

The exact meanings are:

****numbers** = 社交媒體上的最新量化數據，尤其是瀏覽量、讚好數等。 ******

****number** = 「100,000」這個具體數值本身。 ******

Natural translations:

> ******「我不停查看最新的數據，想知道影片是不是已經達到十二萬或十三萬瀏覽量。」 ******

and:

> ******「然而，真正留下來的並不是那個數字本身，而是背後的教訓。」 ******

The highest-value contrasts are:

> ****a number**** → 一個數字

> ****number of views**** → 瀏覽量

- > **latest numbers** → 最新數據
- > **phone number** → 電話號碼
- > **student number** → 學生編號
- > **a number of students** → 一些學生
- > **the number of students** → 學生人數
- > **a musical number** → 歌曲 / 表演節目
- > **grammatical number** → 語法單複數
- > **number the pages** → 給頁面編號
- > **the audience numbered 2,000** → 觀眾共有二千人